

# Found Visualization:

## Christine Sun Kim – When I Play the Deaf Card

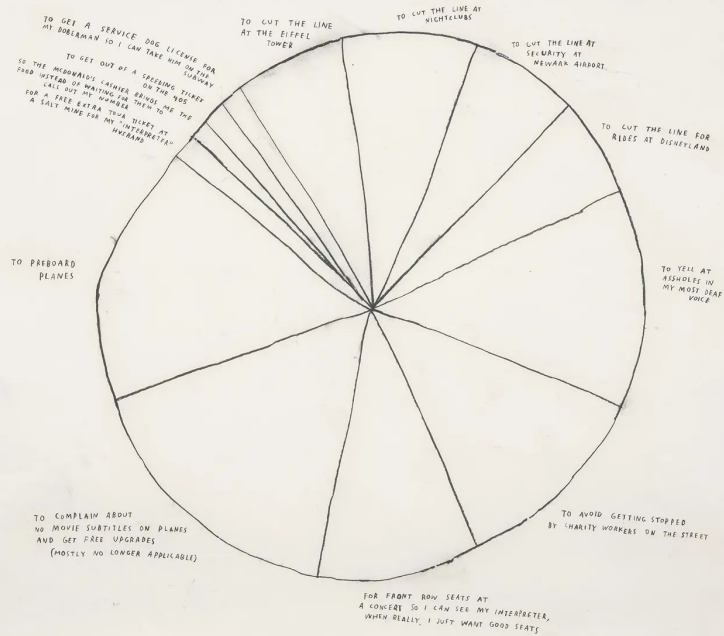
# Christine Sun Kim

Christine Sun Kim (b. 1980) is an American artist based in Berlin whose work raises fundamental questions about sound, voice, and communication. Through drawing, performance, video, installation, and large-scale public works, she explores how sound operates socially, culturally, and politically, often informed by her experience as a Deaf person navigating a society structured around spoken language. Kim utilizes the body, American Sign Language (ASL), musical notation, written text, and infographics to visualize how meaning is transmitted, translated, and mediated across different modes of communication.



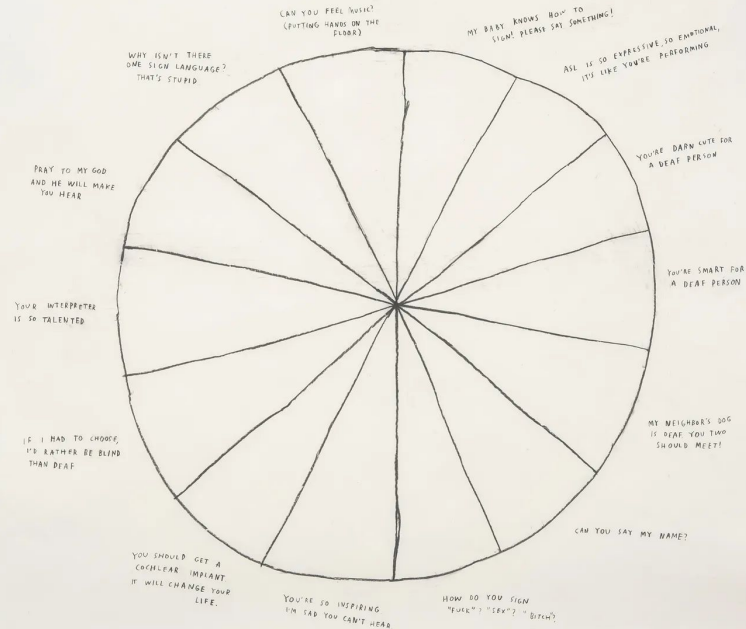
# Data

## WHEN I PLAY THE DEAF CARD



Data Visualization for Architecture, Urbanism, and the Humanities

## SHIT HEARING PEOPLE SAY TO ME

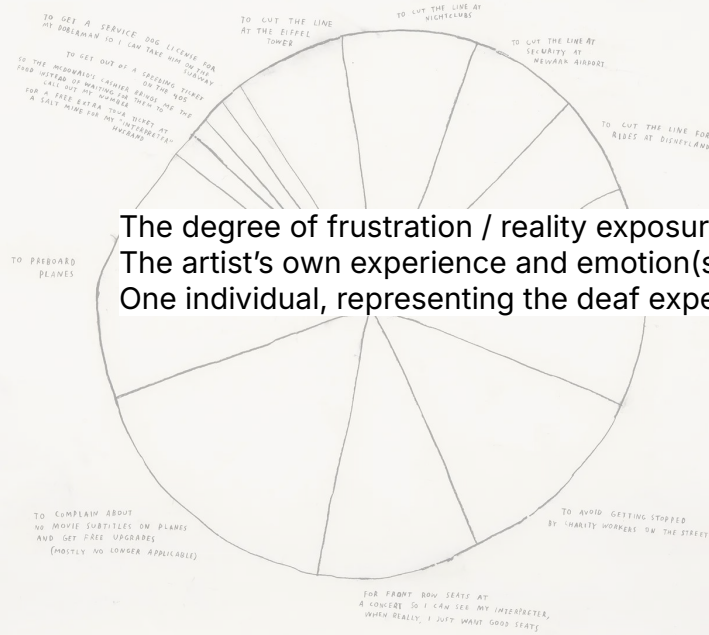


Found Visualization

Rachel Shin

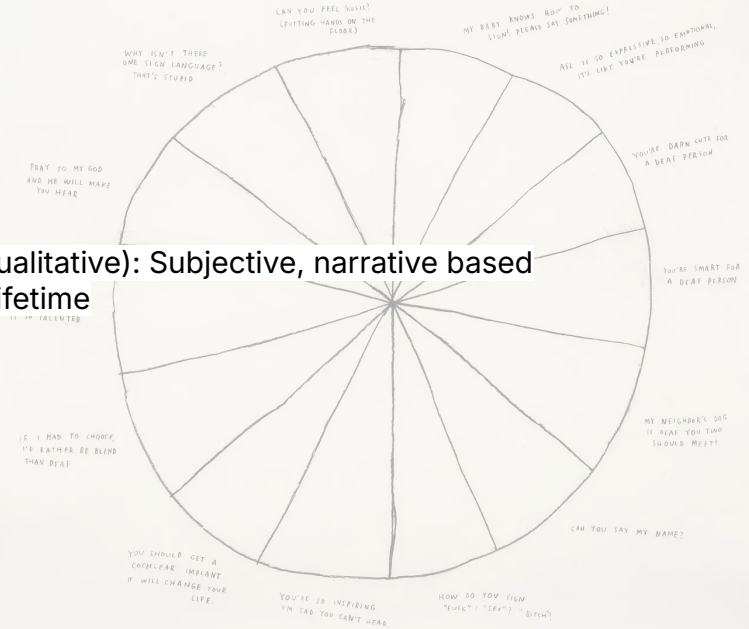
# Basic

## WHEN I PLAY THE DEAF CARD

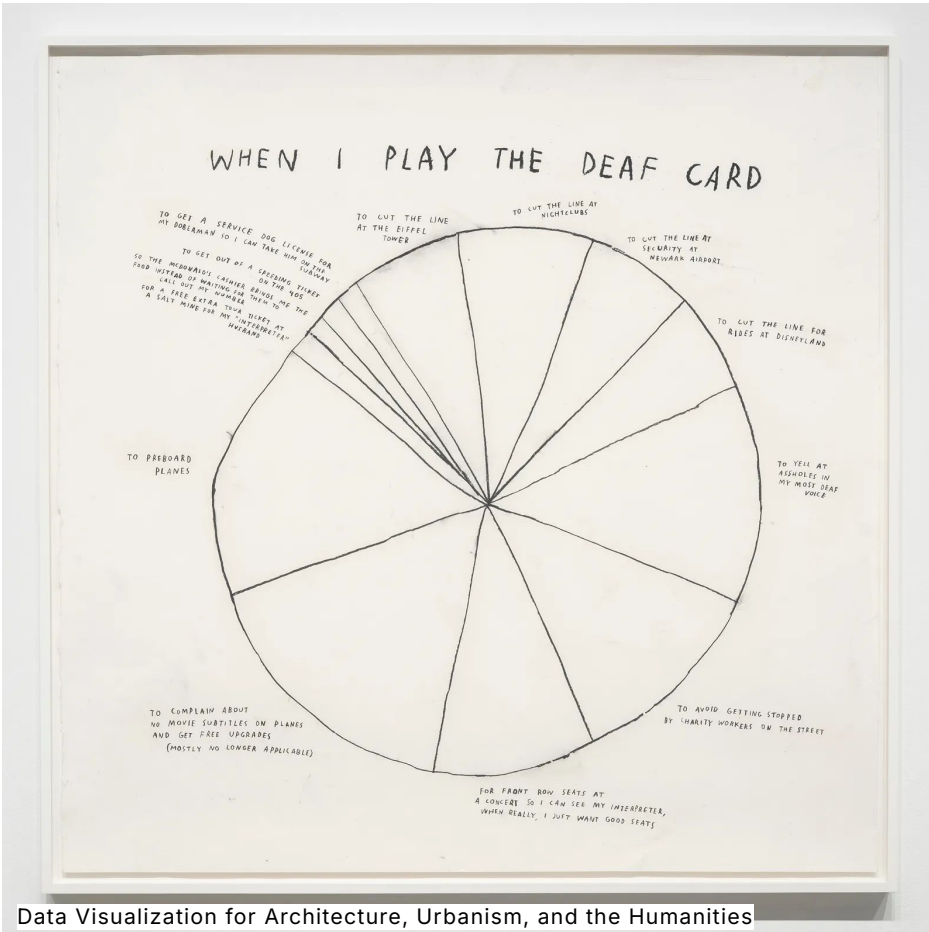


The degree of frustration / reality exposure as a deaf  
 The artist's own experience and emotion(self-reported, qualitative): Subjective, narrative based  
 One individual, representing the deaf experience for the lifetime

## SHIT HEARING PEOPLE SAY TO ME

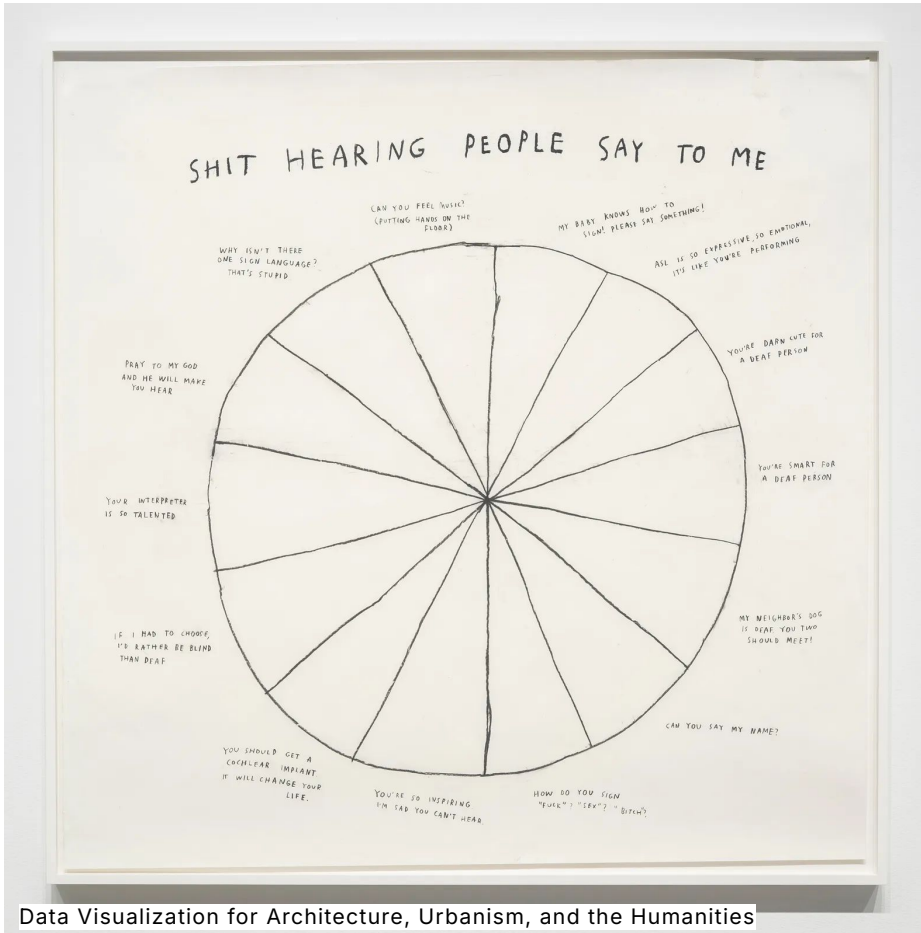


# Dataset 1



- To cut the line at nightclubs
- To cut the line at security at Newark airport
- To cut the line for rides at Disneyland
- To yell at assholes in my most deaf voice
- To avoid getting stopped by charity workers on the street
- For front row seats at a concert so I can see my interpreter, when really, I just want good seats
- To complain about no movie subtitles on planes and get free upgrades(mostly no longer applicable)
- To preboard planes
- For a free extra tour ticket at a salt mine for my "interpreter" husband
- So the Mcdonald's cashier brings me the food instead of waiting for them to call out my number
- To get out of a speeding ticket on the 40s
- To get a service dog license for my doberman so I can take him on the subway
- To cut the line at the Eiffel Tower

# Dataset 2



- My baby knows how to sign! Please say something!
- ASL is so expressive, so emotional, it's like you're performing
- You're darn cute for a deaf person
- You're smart for a deaf person
- My neighbor's dog is deaf. You two should meet!
- Can you say my name?
- How do you sign "fuck"? "Sex"? "Bitch"?
- You're so inspiring  
I'm sad you can't hear
- You should get a cochlear implant. It will change your life.
- If I had to choose, I'd rather be blind than deaf
- Your interpreter is so talented
- Pray to my god and he will make you hear
- Why isn't there one sign language? That's stupid
- Can you feel music?(putting hands on the floor)

# Takeaway

Visualizing the emotional labor created by the absence of access, framed as a matter of "degree."

Layers of interpretation:

Step 1. Gazing infographic visualization

Step 2. Understanding subjective experiences as dataset

Step 3. Digesting the most personal circumstance through the lens of objectivity

How data visualization can be a form of art?

Is it valid?

# Credibility

Trust rests not on statistical validity but on testimony: a member of the community speaks directly is the basis of credibility?

The artist herself became the source

Not measured quantitatively; graded by the artist's judgment without the transparency of the criteria.

Exaggeration and humor signal "this is a subjective scale."

The hand-drawn texture conveys the subtle "responsibility of hand" instead of "mechanical objectivity."

# Function

Audience: Primarily hearing viewers (acknowledging) ↔ secondarily the deaf community (recognition & solidarity)  
Environmental context: Emotional awareness more than information delivery



"Who bears the burden of inaccessibility"

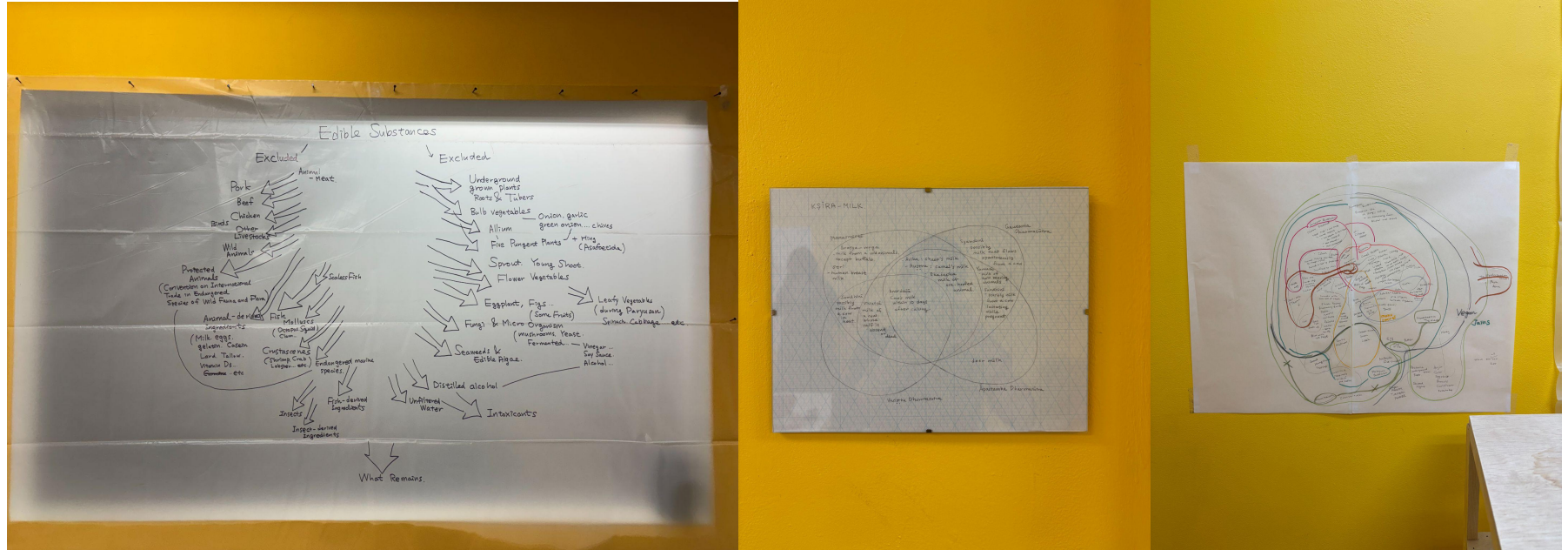
# Reflection

Hand-drawn: the form itself becomes commentary

Subjective data fits in some occasions.

Narrative and intellectual intervention: uncomfortable perspective accessible through humor and form.

## Reference



Minja Gu: "middle ground: (im)possible kitchen"

# Reference



Dear Data by Giorgia Lupi & Stefanie Posavec